



▲ **Eagle Pass** was one of the last stretches to be completed for the Canadian Pacific Railways. Sir Donald Smith drove the last spike at Craigellachie on 7 November 1885.

Human genius

The period from 1870 onwards saw railways engulfing the entire globe reaching as far as Japan, with the first line between Tokyo and Yokohama, in 1872. In 1885, the Canadian Pacific Railway's transcontinental route was completed, creating a second route that spanned an entire continent.

There was no line too difficult or impossible to construct as trains climbed mountains, tore through tunnels, weaved their way through treacherous landscape, and crossed expansive rivers. For instance, the construction of Switzerland's Gotthard Tunnel pushed a main line through 15 km of mountain rock. The landmark Forth Bridge in Scotland opened in 1890, crossing the Firth of Forth for more than 2.5 km. A